DRAGON AND CRANE DOJO

Traditional Karate
Adapted for Today

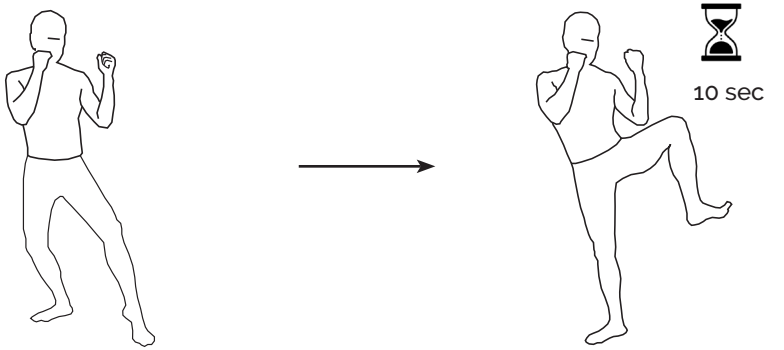
Conditioning Series

Cat and Crane

(Stabilization)

v1.1

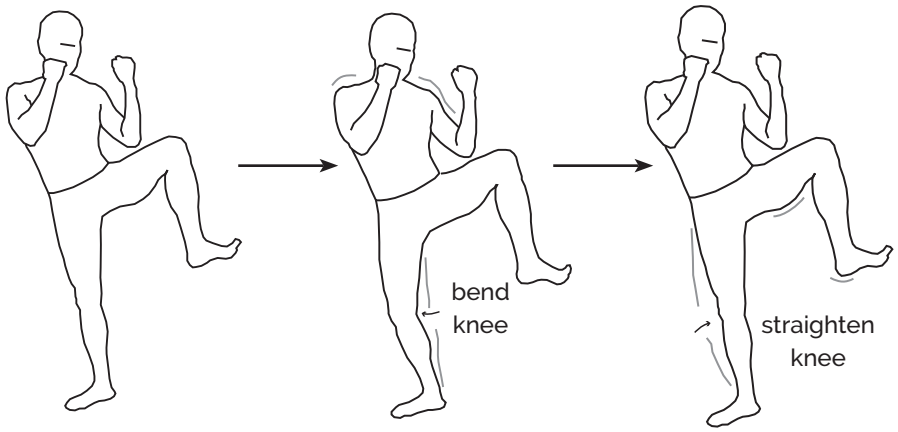
Drill 1: Crane Stance (Stillness)



Start
Cat Stance

Hold crane stance

Drill 2: Low Crane (Tension)

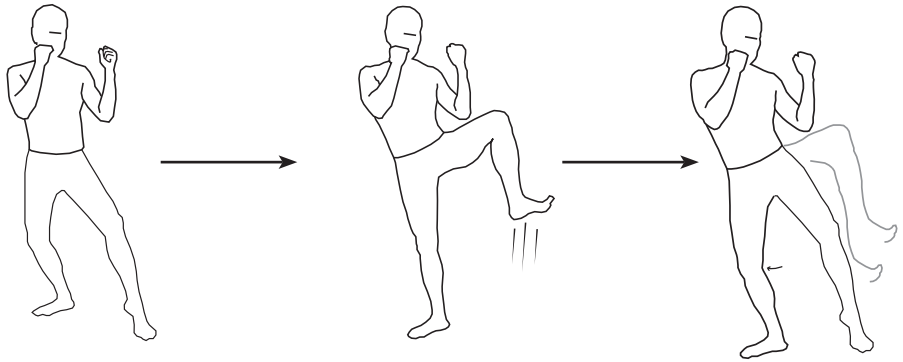


Start
Crane Stance

Slowly
lower body

Raise back
up quickly

Drill 3: Cat and Crane (Vertical Movement)



Start
Cat Stance

Quickly
Up to Crane

Slowly
Down to Cat

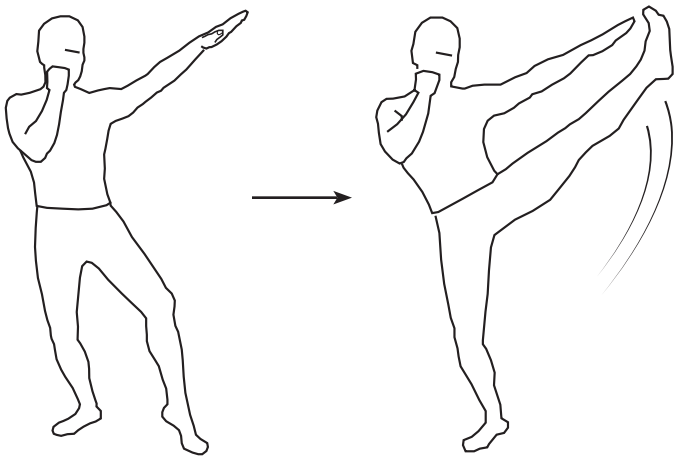
Tips to Improve Balance

Keep
Head Upright

Focus Eyes on
a Fixed Point

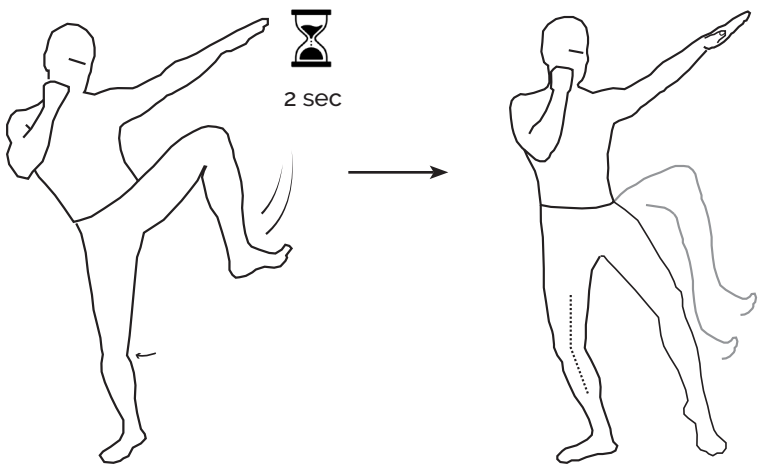
Hands Up
Tight Core

Drill 4: Front Kick (Abrupt Movement)



Start
Crane Stance
Hand as Target

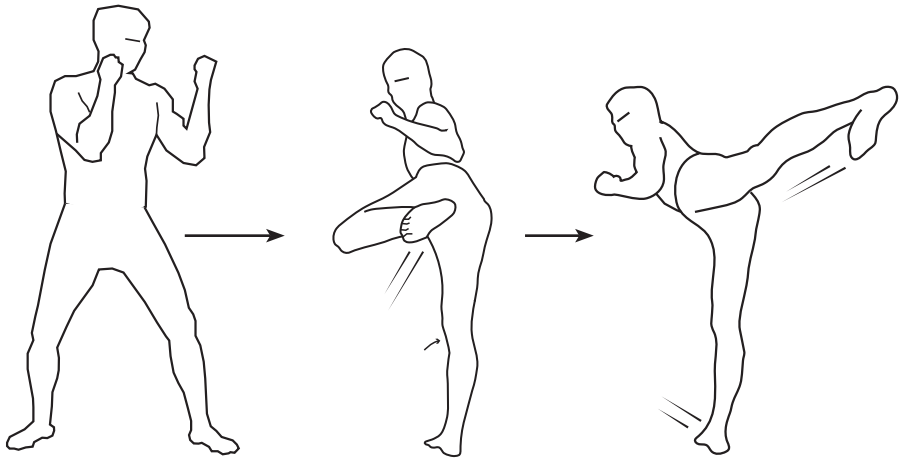
1) Quick Kick
Strike Target



2) Hold Recoil 2 sec

3) Slowly Descend

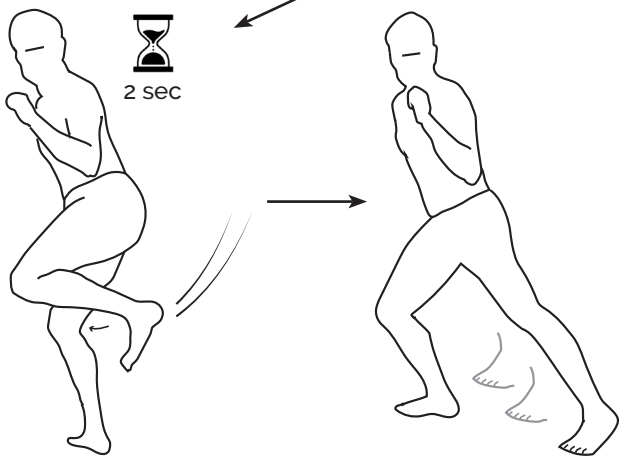
Drill 5: Charging Side Kicks (Linear Momentum)



Start:
Fighting Stance

1) Coil Front Knee

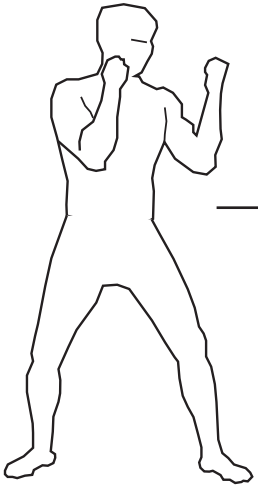
2) Charge in
Side Kick



3) Hold Recoil 2 sec

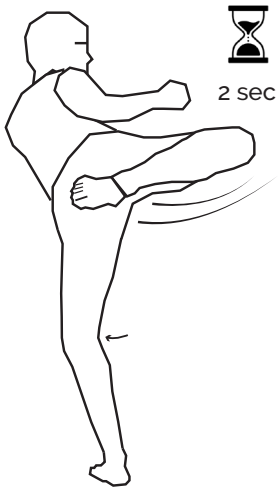
4) Slowly Descend

Drill 6: Round-Back Kick (Angular Momentum*)

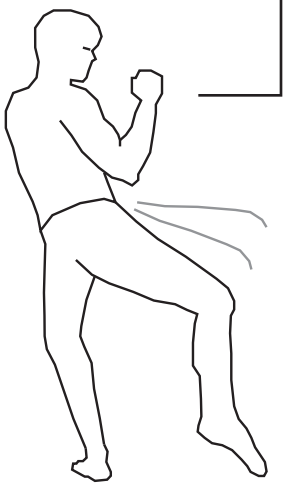


Start: Fighting Stance

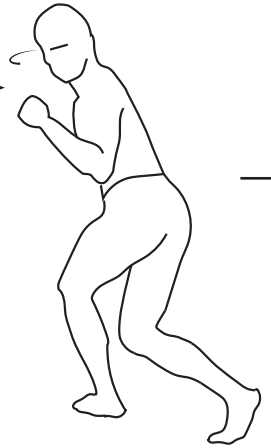
1) Round Kick



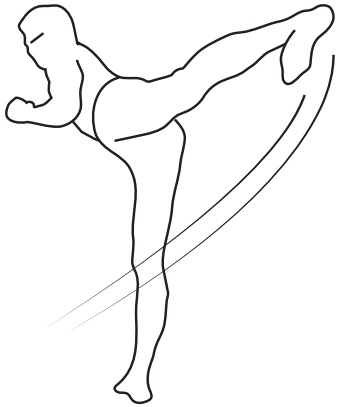
2) Hold Recoil 2 sec



3) Land Slowly

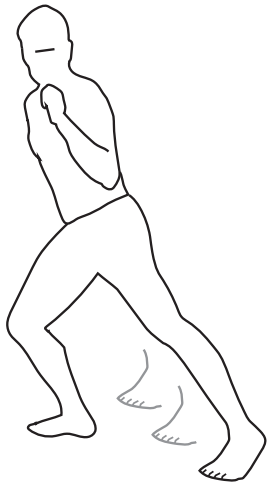


4) Turn and Look



5) Back Kick

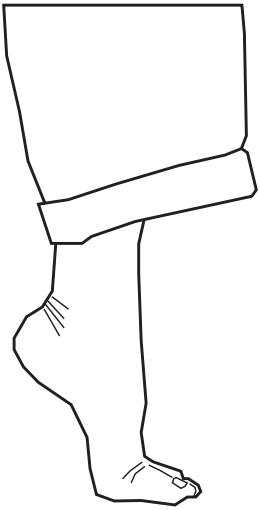
6) Hold Recoil 2 sec



7) Slowly Descend

Drill 6: Done

Bonus Challenge: Redo Drills with Heel Up



Additional Resources

Sensei Seth and Gabriel Varga have good videos on balance as well.

Sensei Seth
youtu.be/JsFICalP5Ls

Gabriel Varga
youtu.be/T2p8xT0tLK4

© 2024 Dragon and Crane Dojo
All rights reserved